



Quick Facts

Mauritius is
visa-free for
Indians

Best time to
visit is from
May-December

There are non-
stop flights to
Mauritius from
metro cities
such as Delhi
and Mumbai

Do not miss a visit to the Chamarel
7-Coloured Earth Geopark—one of the
most popular attractions

| 103

THE FIRST THING that strikes me about Mauritius is how much it feels like home. From the large billboards of State Bank of India advertising everything from home loans to credit cards at the Sir Seewoosagar Ramgoolam International Airport near Port Louis to

Babulal, my chauffeur from the Four Seasons Resort Mauritius at Anahita who greets me in perfect, though accented, Hindi, “Mauritius *mein aapka swagat hai* (Welcome to Mauritius),” as he opens the door of the car. But unlike other countries such as the Gulf, the UK or Canada, where you meet a lot of Indian immigrants,

Babulal, along with half the population of the island nation, is a Mauritian of Indian origin, his ancestors brought to the country from Bihar by the British to work in sugarcane fields in the 19th century.

As we drive from the airport to the resort, I cross large tracts of sugarcane fields. The last time